

OMB Control No: 0970-0114

Expiration date: 03/31/2027

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**Appendix 1: Lead Agency Implementation Plan
for**

State/Territory Rhode Island

FFY 2025 – 2027

Version: Initial Plan

Plan Status: Approved as of 2024-11-09 00:34:15 GMT

For each non-compliance, Lead Agencies must describe the following:

- **Action Steps:** List the action steps needed to correct the finding (e.g., update policy manual, legislative approval, IT system changes, etc.). For each action step list the:
 - o **Expected Completion Date:** List the expected completion date for the action step.
- **Overall Target Date for Compliance:** List date Lead Agency anticipates completing implementation, achieving full compliance with all aspects of the findings. (Note: Compliance will not be determined until the FFY 2025-2027 CCDF Plan is amended and approved).

ELIGIBILITY AND ENROLLMENT:CONTINUITY OF CARE (12-MONTH ELIGIBILITY)

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not always provide a minimum 12-month eligibility period for each child, as required by 98.21(a)(1). (Plan Questions 2.5.2a and 2.5.2c)

Overall Target Completion Date: 06/30/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Promulgate CCAP Regulations including cost benefit analysis and fiscal note related to 24-month CCAP certificate period.	06/30/2025
2	Bridges System Updates and Enhancements for 24-month CCAP certificate functionality. This includes: (1) Fifteen 60-minute Technical Design Sessions for system (Bridges) enhancement, (2) Functional Design Document Review and Approval, (3) Technical Design Document Review and Approval and (4) System Testing.	05/30/2025
3	Launch 24-month eligibility period to ensure all children receive more than the minimum required 12-months of eligibility.	06/30/2025
4	Operations training materials for 24-month CCAP certificate period updated or developed and deployed	05/30/2025
5	CCAP Operations trainings on new policy and system functionality updated and deployed.	03/31/2025
6	Communications Plan and deployment to community, customers, partners and staff.	04/30/2025

EQUAL ACCESS:PAYMENT PRACTICES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not pay all provider types prospectively or alternatively does not demonstrate that it is not a generally-accepted practice for all provider types, as required by 98.45(m)(1). (Plan Question 4.4.1a). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through August 1, 2026.
- The Lead Agency does not pay based on enrollment or alternatively does not provide justification that this is impracticable or is not a generally-accepted practice, as required by 98.45(m)(2). (Plan Question 4.4.1b). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through August 1, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 04/30/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Define policy and parameters around paying based on enrollment.	01/31/2025
2	Promulgate regulations for payment based on enrollment	02/28/2025
3	Redesign system functionality (Bridges) attendance processes to reflect payment based on enrollment	04/30/2025
4	Communication plan and deployment for Providers on payment based on enrollment	04/30/2025
5	Communication plan and deployment for Customers on payment based on enrollment	04/30/2025
6	Training for internal staff on payment based on enrollment	04/30/2025
7	Define policy and parameters around paying providers prospectively	06/30/2025
8	Promulgate CCAP Regulations including cost benefit analysis and fiscal note related to prospective payment	09/30/2025
9	Bridges System Updates and Enhancements for prospective functionality. This includes (1) Technical Design Sessions for system (Bridges) enhancement, (2) Functional Design Document Review and Approval, (3) Technical Design Document Review and Approval and (4) system testing.	02/28/2026
10	Launch Prospective Payments	03/31/2026

11	Operations training materials for prospective payment developed	03/31/2026
12	CCAP Operations trainings on new policy and system functionality deployed	03/31/2026
13	Communication plan re: prospective payment and deployment to community and customers	02/01/2026
14	Communication plan re: prospective payment and deployment to partners and internal staff	02/01/2026

PROGRAM INTEGRITY: EFFECTIVE FISCAL MANAGEMENT PRACTICES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency is on a corrective action plan (CAP) for an error rate over 10% reflecting that not all of its fiscal management and internal control practices are sufficiently effective, as required by 98.68(a). (Plan Questions 10.1.2, 10.1.3, 10.1.4, 10.1.5a, and 10.1.6a)

Overall Target Completion Date: 12/30/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Ongoing adherence to the ACF-405 corrective action plan (CAP)	12/30/2025

EQUAL ACCESS: PAYMENT RATES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency's payment rates for infants in center-based care and preschoolers in center-based care are not sufficient to ensure equal access, as required by 98.45(a). (Plan Question 4.3.2a)

Overall Target Completion Date: 01/30/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Continue to advocate for legislation that moves the rates to at least the 50th percentile across the board.	06/30/2025
2	Put in a decision package for FY27 that raises rates to at least the 50th percentile for infants and preschool.	08/29/2025
3	Use Preschool Development Grant funding to look at piloting infant rate increases in the interim to support the infant/toddler sector based on what RI applied for. Use data from pilot to support rate increases in the future through legislation.	08/29/2025

EQUAL ACCESS:PROVIDER OPTIONS FOR PARENTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not provide grants or contracts for direct services for infants and toddlers, for children in underserved geographic areas, and for children with disabilities, as required by 98.30(b)(1). (Plan Questions 4.1.1c and 4.5.1i). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through August 1, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 08/31/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Meet with the Early Learning Council to discuss ways we can provide grants and contracts in Rhode Island and how to pilot it. Also, work with ACF on TA for states that are doing this successfully and if that is separate and apart from their eligibility system.	03/31/2025
2	Create a workplan for pilot of grants and contracts for one of the key direct service groups, infants and toddlers, due to funding priority for that area.	06/30/2025
3	Kickoff pilot of grants and contracts for infant and toddler ☐ anticipate a one year pilot to assess	06/30/2026

	challenges, successes and tweak a workplan. Gather data during this time period.	
4	Scale up pilot based on information gathers to focus on all three direct service types.	08/31/2026

PROGRAM INTEGRITY:FRAUD INVESTIGATION, PAYMENT RECOVERY, AND SANCTIONS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not include the results of the activities to investigate and recover fraudulent payments, as required by 98.68(b)(2). (Plan Question 10.2.2b)

Overall Target Completion Date: 08/29/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Gather data from first six months of internal monitoring for CCAP. Work with CCAP and financial management on process for re-monitoring, recouping and result management.	03/31/2025
2	Work with Financial Management to create an internal Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for determining fraud in a consistent way for all CCDF funding.	06/30/2025
3	Ensure that SOP's for investigating and recovering improper payments due to fraud are created and implemented for all of the following: (1) provider fraud (2) client fraud, (3) staff fraud (4) vendors & contractors	09/01/2025
4	Work with CCRU (Claims, Collections & Recovery Unit) & OIA (Office of Internal Audits) to ensure an updated MOU is created and signed for all fraud that is found from outside of child care's internal processes. Begin monthly meetings with both entities to go over cases, workplan, etc.	09/01/2025